

Eastern gorilla

Gorilla beringei

- ↔ 4–6 ft (1.2–1.8 m)
- 📍 C. and E. Africa
- ⊗ Endangered

The eastern gorilla lives in the Rift Valley region near Lake Victoria, and is divided into two races: the mountain gorilla and the eastern lowland gorilla. Both types live in family groups, led and defended by a dominant male gorilla with pale gray fur on his back. Known as a silverback, the dominant male fathers most or all the young in the group. Adult males are much bigger than females, weighing up to 460 lb (210 kg). Gorillas mainly eat plant material including leaves, fruit, nuts, berries, and juicy roots, and occasionally insects such as termites and ants.

Bonobo

Pan paniscus

- ↔ 28–33 in (70–83 cm)
- 📍 C. Africa
- ⊗ Endangered

A close relative of the chimpanzee, and thought to be the same species until 1929, the bonobo is slimmer, with longer limbs. It has mostly black skin, and the hair on its crown has a distinctive central part. The bonobo feeds chiefly on the ground and has a varied diet of fruit, seeds, leaves, flowers, fungi, bird eggs, and small animals. Groups of up to 100 bonobos gather to sleep at night, but they generally split up into smaller groups to forage for food, mainly on the ground. Females are dominant and leave their family groups when mature; males tend to stay on.

Other species

- **Aye-aye**
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Bats

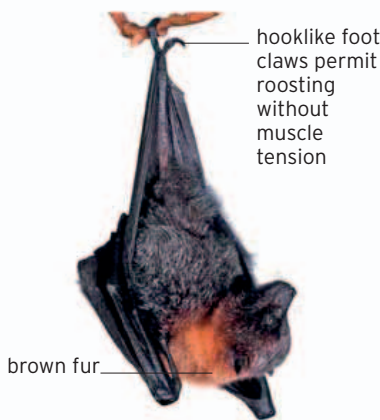
Order Chiroptera

Rodrigues flying fox

Pteropus rodricensis

- ↔ 14 in (35 cm)
- 📍 Indian Ocean (Rodrigues Island)
- ⊗ Critically endangered

The flying foxes are named for their foxy, pointed faces, which differ from those of most other bats. This species is a fruit bat, found only on Rodrigues Island, where it feeds at



night on ripe fruit and returns at dawn to roost in trees. Human disturbance and destruction due to tropical cyclones has made it rare.

Egyptian rousette

Rousettus aegyptiacus

- ↔ 6–7 in (15–18 cm)
- 📍 W. Asia, N. Africa (Egypt), W., E., and Southern Africa
- ⊗ Common

The Egyptian rousette and a few of its close relatives are the only fruit bats to use a form of echolocation, which is similar to that used by insectivorous bats. This helps it to find its way around and roost in dark caves. More widespread across Africa than its name suggests, it is seen as a pest by fruit farmers.



Proboscis bat

Rhynchonycteris naso

- ↔ 1½–2 in (3.5–5 cm)
- 📍 Mexico to C. South America
- ⊗ Common

Found across most of Amazonia and parts of Central America, the proboscis bat owes its name to its long, pointed nose. This insect-eater lives in small groups that use echolocation to hunt for airborne insects at night, usually over water. By day, the groups of up to 40 roost together on a branch or a wooden beam, typically lying nose-to-tail.

Lesser mouse-tailed bat

Rhinopoma hardwickii

- ↔ 2–3 in (5–8 cm)
- 📍 W. to S. Asia, N. and E. Africa
- ⊗ Common

The mouse-tailed bats are a small group of insectivorous bats that are unique for their thin, trailing tails, like those of mice. Favoring dry habitats, this species preys mainly on beetles and moths; when these are scarce in the dry season, it lies dormant, sustained by body fat built up when food is abundant.

Lesser horseshoe bat

Rhinolophus hipposideros

- ↔ 2 in (5 cm)
- 📍 Europe, N. Africa to W. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Named for its horseshoe-shaped nose leaf, this is one of the smallest insectivorous bats. It hunts at night for small insects and spiders. Widespread across the warmer parts of Europe, it roosts by day in tree holes, caves, and manmade structures. It hibernates in deep caverns throughout the winter.

Ghost bat

Macroderma gigas

- ↔ 4–5 in (10–13 cm)
- 📍 W. and N. Australia
- ⊗ Vulnerable

This long-winged bat can seize frogs, mice, small snakes, and even roosting birds in its long, curved claws. It locates them at night by sight and by using echolocation, and kills them with a neck bite. It is called the ghost bat as the skin of its wings is unusually thin, giving it a ghostly appearance as it flies overhead in the moonlight.